

Emotion before facts

One-card field guide

Core move

- Acknowledge emotional impact before facts, correction, explanation or details.
- Accuracy stays; the order changes.

Formula

- Feeling signal -> brief validation -> bridge -> facts/details/next step.
- Use "and" or "the detail is," not a dismissive "but."

Minimum move

- That sounds frustrating. The detail I want to check is...
- One human sentence before the factual sentence.

Use when

- The person is upset and facts also matter.
- A correction would sound cold if delivered first.

Avoid when

- Immediate safety facts must come first.
- The person explicitly asks for data first.

Recovery

- I jumped to the facts too fast. Let me back up.
- I may have named that wrong; what is the feeling closer to?